

Software Deployment to Production

Department:	IT – DevOps	Document Owner:	DevOps Lead
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1. Purpose

Define a controlled, repeatable process for deploying application changes to the production environment with minimal risk and downtime.

2. Scope

All application deployments to production. Emergency hotfixes follow the abbreviated process in Appendix A.

3. Procedure

Step 1: Change Request Submission

Developer or PM submits Change Request (CR) in Jira with: description of change, affected systems, rollback plan, and deployment steps. CR requires technical lead review before scheduling.

Step 2: Change Advisory Board (CAB) Review

Standard changes reviewed at weekly CAB meeting (Thursdays, 2 PM). CR must be submitted 3 business days before CAB. CAB approves, rejects, or requests more information. Emergency changes follow fast-track process.

Step 3: Pre-Deployment Testing

Developer runs full regression suite in staging environment. QA signs off on test results. Load test required for changes affecting core transaction flows. Security scan required for all external-facing changes.

Step 4: Deployment Window

Standard deployments: Tuesday or Thursday 6–8 PM ET. High-risk deployments: Saturday 2–4 AM ET. Notify stakeholders 24 hours before deployment. Freeze on deployments: last 2 weeks of fiscal quarter.

Step 5: Deployment Execution

DevOps engineer follows deployment runbook step-by-step. Enable maintenance mode if user-facing downtime expected. Run smoke tests within 10 minutes post-deployment. Monitor error rates and performance metrics for 30 minutes.

Step 6: Post-Deployment Validation

QA validates key user journeys in production. Business owner signs off on critical features. If issues detected, execute rollback plan immediately. Document deployment results in CR ticket.

4. References & Related Documents

- Change Management Policy OPS-002
- Deployment Runbook Template
- Rollback Procedures Guide

5. Revision History

Version	Date	Description of Change
4.1	2024-02-15	Added fiscal quarter freeze period
4.0	2023-09-01	Adopted CI/CD pipeline
3.5	2023-01-01	Added security scan requirement